foreign investors to India and negotiated a large number of collaborative agreements.'[2]

An echo of this view can be found in former President of the World Bank, George Woods' assessment of Shroff. Woods, then Chairman of First Boston Corporation, had invited Shroff to visit America in 1960 and apprise industrialists there about the conditions in India. Woods said: 'Nobody could accuse A.D. Shroff of hiding his opinions and in the later years of his life, very rarely were those opinions fashionable in India. Yet few patriots did more than he did to make friends for the Indian nation and to build confidence in that nation among those throughout the world whose business it is to provide capital for sound investment opportunity.'

While admitting that planned development involved a certain measure of control and regulation, Shroff urged that within the framework of planned development, every individual should have the largest possible scope for making his or her contribution by the use of individual initiative and enterprise. Shroff criticised government policies and action when he felt that regulations and controls were defeating the very objective of a rapid planned development of the country. Excessive regulation and control lead to concentration of power in the hands of the bureaucracy and tend to regimentation of economic life. The founders of the Forum also believed that excessive regulation and control of the economy in its various aspects would lead to a gradual diminution in the democratic way of life assured by the Constitution. Shroff displayed enormous courage and conviction in whatever he did. In fact, as Minoo Shroff puts it, 'he often relished swimming against the tide.'[3]

Shroff was not ashamed of saying that the profit motive must continue to exist, if society is to progress and develop. It is necessary to remember that Shroff's espousal of the cause of free enterprise was not the result of a dogma but a deep-rooted faith in the democratic values of the dignity of the individual. He also wanted the people of India to realise that democracy would be impossible without free enterprise. With Eugene R. Black Sr, Shroff held that people must come to accept private enterprise not as a necessary evil but as an affirmative good. The government naturally disapproved of the Forum.

The freedom Shroff visualised and unremittingly advocated for private enterprise was not an ideal bereft of responsibility; he consistently